Dark Touch — Open Questions

Decisions still to make for the Dark Touch GDD. Tick an item when it is decided, then move the decision into the GDD or its companion documents.

Combat and abilities

- [ ] Final names of the abilities (except Unholy Impale).
- [ ] The two variants of each ability.
- [ ] Whether aimed abilities get a soft-targeting assist or stay raw aim (decided during prototyping).
- [ ] Rework the ability kit into a proper rotation, beyond one filler and one spender per role, and decide which abilities combo with each other.
- [ ] Which abilities, if any, can be cast while moving.
- [ ] How Spirit regenerates or is gained.
- [ ] What causes stuns, for the player and for enemies.
- [ ] Rounding direction for damage: to the nearest whole number, or always down?

Army and soldiers

- [ ] Player abilities granted by Mages and Rogues.
- [ ] When a type’s ability is available: with at least one soldier of that type, always, or something else.
- [ ] How soldier-granted abilities fit on the action bar.
- [ ] Grade and rank odds per difficulty tier.
- [ ] Does a raised elite keep its aura and stat boost?
- [ ] Do raised soldiers that die during a run stay dead until the run ends?
- [ ] How the 10 army slots unlock over time.
- [ ] The exact level rule for raising a mob.
- [ ] The list of orders players can give, and which spells direct soldiers.
- [ ] Whether stances or behaviours are set per command group.
- [ ] How starting soldiers are chosen before a run, from the soldiers kept.

Enemies and level

- [ ] Enemy roster for the level: which types appear, how often, how many elites.
- [ ] The boss of the level: design and mechanics.
- [ ] Level layout: the mix of rooms and open areas, hidden chest placement, run length for the one-level demo.
- [ ] The size and source of the random name list.

Progression

- [ ] Talismans: stats they boost, rarity, drop rates, how many can be owned, whether found ones are kept after a death.
- [ ] Experience and levels: what levelling gives during a run and across runs.
- [ ] The level-up choice during a run: what is offered.
- [ ] The talent list, including talents that change how Souls are gained.
- [ ] Which variants unlock at which level.
- [ ] Difficulty tiers: how many, how each is unlocked, how much stats and grade odds scale.

Presentation

- [ ] Look of the dark-magic arm effect.
- [ ] Is the rank aura visible on living mobs, or only on corpses and soldiers? How do elites look now that auras show rank?
- [ ] Music: how much phonk to blend in, and in which layers.
- [ ] UI: screen order, and the UI Designer’s model.
- [ ] Default assignment of the 14 key slots between spells, command groups and orders.
- [ ] Accessibility options, such as reducing camera shake.
- [ ] Lore beyond the opening story: the entity, the war, the factions.

Balance

- [ ] All numbers: damage, HP, cooldowns, cast times, Spirit costs, the revive cost, Reap buff values, talisman boosts.